

Substances are so Addictive...so why do they have to be cute too? — Game Specification Documents

MAIN GAME SPEC — “Substances are so Addictive...so why do they have to be cute too?”

1. Overview / Purpose

A point-and-click dating simulator where the player interacts with five charming characters who each represent a different drink — balancing affection and sobriety as the story unfolds. Players navigate branching conversations, minigames, and emotional choices to reach good or bad endings for each route.

Elevator Pitch: Flirt responsibly. A fully voiced, retro-inspired dating sim where every choice—and every sip—matters. Keep your affection high and your sobriety higher.

2. Scope

Included:

- Five unique, fully voiced characters with individual story routes
- Branching dialogue trees with affection and sobriety outcomes
- Two meters: Sobriety and Affection
- Minigames to regain sobriety or lose affection
- Good and bad endings per route
- Full art and UI presentation
- Point-and-click interface for interaction

Excluded:

- Multiplayer or online functionality
- NSFW scenes or suggestive content
- Outfit changes or visual customization
- Multi-character route overlaps
- Inventory or collectible systems

3. Functional & Non-functional Requirements

Functional:

- Player can select dialogue options that affect affection and sobriety meters
- Player participates in timed or reflex-based minigames to influence sobriety
- Each route contains a branching narrative with multiple endings
- Visual novel-style text and portrait system displays voiced dialogue
- Sobriety and affection persist throughout each playthrough
- UI reflects meter changes in real time

Non-functional:

- Art and UI maintain a consistent classic dating game aesthetic
- Game loop designed for short sessions (10–15 minutes per route)
- All voice lines recorded with clear, consistent audio quality
- Interface is intuitive and accessible via mouse

DIALOGUE SYSTEM SPEC — “Romantic Branching Interaction”

1. Overview / Purpose

The dialogue system handles branching narrative interactions, determining how player choices impact affection and sobriety. Each character’s route progresses through dialogue-based decision trees leading to distinct outcomes.

Elevator Pitch: Talk sweetly, but choose wisely — your words can raise hearts or cloud judgment.

2. Scope

Included:

- Click-based dialogue progression system
- Affection and sobriety modifiers applied to each dialogue choice
- Dialogue trees with branching outcomes
- Conditional choices based on meter values
- Voiceover and character art integration per line
- Support for good/bad ending dialogue outcomes

Excluded:

- Procedural or randomized dialogue generation
- AI-driven responses or dynamic tone detection
- Multi-character conversations in a single scene

3. Functional & Non-functional Requirements

Functional:

- Dialogue choices modify affection/sobriety based on player selection
- Dialogue trees stored in JSON or scriptable data format
- UI updates meter visuals and available options in real time
- Supports saving/loading mid-conversation
- End-of-route dialogues reflect accumulated stats for endings

Non-functional:

- Dialogue pacing and transitions align with voiced performance
- Interface remains minimal and easily readable
- Dialogue box aesthetics match retro color palette

METERS & MINIGAME SPEC — “Affection and Sobriety Systems”

1. Overview / Purpose

The meters and minigame system visualize player progress and emotional balance throughout the story. Sobriety influences clarity in dialogue, while affection reflects relationship growth. Minigames serve as a means to restore sobriety or risk affection loss.

Elevator Pitch: Stay sharp, stay sober — master minigames to keep your cool and win their heart.

2. Scope

Included:

- Sobriety and Affection meters displayed in the UI
- Dynamic updates to reflect dialogue and gameplay outcomes
- Minigames that temporarily shift focus from dialogue to skill challenge
- Win/fail conditions directly tied to meter changes
- Integration with GameManager to persist data across scenes

Excluded:

- Competitive leaderboards or scoring systems
- Complex multi-step puzzle mechanics
- Randomized or endless minigame modes

3. Functional & Non-functional Requirements

Functional:

- Sobriety and Affection values stored as persistent player variables
- Minigames reward success with sobriety gain and penalize failure with affection loss
- Dialogue events read current meter values to adjust available responses
- Visual feedback (animations, sounds) for meter changes
- Failure states trigger alternate dialogue or early ending conditions

Non-functional:

- Minigames last 30–60 seconds to maintain pacing
- UI elements are clear about the benefits and consequences
- Performance optimized for short play sessions